These schemes proved to be total non-starters. The Rs 1 trillion agriculture infrastructure investment scheme did not take off in financial year 2020–21. For 2021–22, it has been approved as an interest subsidy scheme. Going by the track record of quite a few such infrastructure creation schemes in agriculture and the allied sector, there is very little likelihood of farmgate infrastructure getting created under the scheme. The FOF scheme was announced with a lot of fanfare. However, the budget outlay for the year 2020–21 was reduced from Rs 200 crore to Rs 150 crore in the revised estimates (RE) and a modest provision of Rs 250 crore was made for financial year 2021–22. Not a single investment was made in any FOF scheme during the year.

Of the Garib Kalyan package announced on 26 March, additional free foodgrains (5 kg of wheat/rice and 1 kg of dal) to 80 crore ration card holders for three months cost the government approximately Rs 30,000 crore; Rs 500 per month for three months to 20 crore women Jan Dhan account holders cost another Rs 30,000 crore; and three free cylinders to 8 crore Ujjwala scheme LPG connection holders cost about Rs 10,000 crore. Other fiscal measures—Rs 1000 to 3 crore pension holders and payment of PF contribution—cost more than Rs 5000 crore. All these added up to a maximum of Rs 75,000 crore. The fact that the government continued with the free ration scheme for the entire 2021–22 testifies to the fact of massive loss of incomes for a big proportion of India’s 40 crore workers.

The government also announced a Rs 40,000 crore additional provision for the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA) over and above the Rs 61,500 crore provision in Budget 2020–21. One-time subsidy component of the Credit Linked Subsidy Scheme (CLSS) was revived (it was closed in 2019–20) to generate an investment of Rs 70,000 crore in 2020–21. Assuming that the entire Rs 70,000 crore of affordable housing work will be completed, Rs 14,000 crore of fiscal expenditure would be incurred by the government.